

Medical practice differs in Canada

By Rosemary MacVicar,
Gazette reporter

The newest member of the Almonte General Hospital staff, Dr Franz Ferraris, has found that differences between Canada and his native South Africa aren't just political — they're medical as well.

The nature of disease differs radically in the two countries, for one thing. "You see a lot of textbook medicine and a lot of very sick (patients)," in South Africa, commented Dr Ferraris.

He has been providing anaesthetic services at Almonte General for approximately one month and will be setting up a general medical practice at a yet undetermined location in early March.

Dr Ferraris moved to Canada in 1982. Before that time he practised medicine in South Africa for about six years.

Medicine revolves largely around the "basic illnesses of developing nations," in South Africa, commented Dr Ferraris. He treated more tuberculosis and infectious diseases in that country. In contrast he has been exposed to more depression, anxieties and other less physical illness "that go with high speed modern living," in Canadian patients.

At one point he worked in an exclusively black area at a 1,800-bed hospital in Zululand. "Most patients would have been to see the tribal doctor first," he said.

Approaching tribal doctors was automatic even among educated natives. "The (tribal doctors') methods of diagnoses were quite good, but their treatments fell a bit short," he commented.

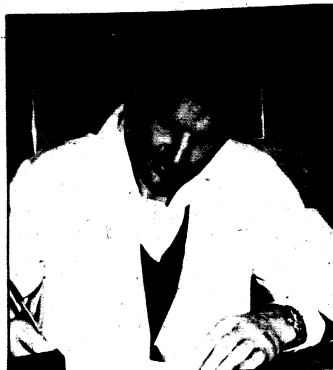
Dr Ferraris said the problem area was often marked or outlined on the patient by a tribal doctor before the patient visited a medical doctor.

He gained experience with trauma cases in South Africa when treating blacks who were injured through tribal fighting. The mortality rate in the area of the hospital where he worked in 1979-80 ranged between 13 and 20 a week.

Dr Ferraris spent part of his compulsory two-year military service as one of two doctors in a 300-bed hospital in Namibia on the Angolan border. The hospital treated civilians injured in the war.

He originally left South Africa for Saskatchewan almost by accident when his plans to take a post in Bermuda failed. He was then attracted to the province by the presence of other South African doctors working there.

Dr Ferraris began practising medicine in Canada filling temporary vacancies created by doctors who were taking leaves for holidays, illness or other reasons.



Dr Franz Ferraris has been working at Almonte General Hospital for the past month. Dr Ferraris, was raised and educated in South Africa.

Dr Ferraris came to Almonte after working as a general practitioner in Coronack, Sask. During the last two years he was the sole doctor serving the town of approximately 1,300 and a surrounding area population of 3,500 to 5,000.

In total Dr Ferraris has about eight years of experience in both South Africa and Saskatchewan. He was born and educated in South Africa.

He graduated in medicine from the University of Cape Town and completed his internship at the Edendale, Pretoria and Kimberly hospitals in Cape Town. Dr Ferraris received anaesthetic and emergency training at the military and Carltonville hospitals in South Africa.

The winter climate and the attitude towards medical care were two differences Dr Ferraris had to become accustomed to in Canada.

He said he has found Canadians tend to take their medical care, which is generally readily available, for granted more than South Africans. Blanket health insurance such as OHIP in Ontario, doesn't exist in his native land. Instead the health insurance is similar to the American system.

Dr Ferraris is looking forward to putting down roots in Almonte with his wife Terry. The couple are planning a six-week vacation to South Africa in the near future. After this break, Dr Ferraris plans to establish his practice.

Almonte, he said, offered a "majority of the right ingredients" he was seeking in a new post. In addition to being well-located and offering professional opportunities, Dr Ferraris said the friendliness of the residents was another attraction.

He replaced Dr Rainer Karrei who died earlier this summer.

Pool hall helped shape Almonte youth

By Gerry Wheatley

In a previous article on the Shipman House, it appears I gave insufficient recognition to an important cultural institution to two generations of Almonte youth.

I agree with those who raised the question that history must record those events which contribute to the shaping of the youth of our nation. That cultural institution that helped shape the youth of Almonte was "Rooney's Pool Hall." I apologize. Rooney's does deserve more than three lines in the history of the Shipman House.

It was noted in the previous article that Michael Rooney purchased the Shipman House in 1948. This was correct, but it was only a change in ownership of the building and the first time since 1862 that the ownership of the Shipman House and the Almo Apartments had been separated.

Pat Rooney owned and operated a business in the Shipman House before 1948, but he did not own the building. After Pat turned over the business to his son, Mike, he decided to buy the building.

I have not found any records, but local memories say Pat Rooney was a barber in the building in the 1930s and perhaps before that. There were three entrances at the front of the building at that time. The left entrance was to a tailor shop owned by Mr Robinson, the centre door led to Pat Rooney's Barber Shop, and the right entrance was to Rooney's Tobacco Shop and Pool Hall. In the pool hall, there were pool tables downstairs and one large snooker table upstairs.

Pat Rooney had three sons. Michael continued his father's business, Pat was a barber with his father before

the war but did not return to barbering after the war, and Joe worked in the pool hall in his younger years, then moved west. Pat's sister Alma also was involved for a time in running the pool hall.

The pool hall, of course, was restricted to those age 18 years and over. It was a challenge to all younger teenagers to sneak past Mike into the pool room. From the reports of many readers, most made it past Mike except John Rooney, Mike's nephew. Prior to age 18, John Rooney used the pool tables only on Sunday when he was helping clean the pool room. Considering John's skill with a cue, he must have cleaned up on a lot of Sundays.

Reports indicate Rooney's was a "cultural centre" to adults as well as to teenagers, and these were males only. Rooney's was one of the last bastions of male supremacy in Almonte. A proper lady could not be seen in Rooney's.

I would like to pass on to you the many stories I have been told about the events and activities that went on at Rooney's. Unfortunately, some laws and good taste stipulate that most of those stories cannot be put into print. It must suffice to say that Rooney's was a barber shop, tobacconist, pool hall, and more, and made a major cultural contribution to two generations of Almonte youth as they grew to manhood.

My thanks to John Rooney of Almonte for sharing his memories of his grandfather, Pat, father Pat, uncles Mike and Joe, and the colorful business of Rooney's Pool Hall. Thanks also to the many others who passed on to me their stories of Rooney's and because of the nature of those stories cannot be named in print.

Town club enjoys supper

The annual Christmas party of the Almonte Senior Citizens Club was held in the Legion hall Dec 16.

The evening began with a potluck supper. The choir gave some Christmas selections under the director Mary Kelly with Gwen Ralph at the piano.

A delightful program was arranged by the ministerial association. Mel Foster introduced the master of ceremonies, Rev Paul Rumball who led the devotions.

Mrs Hazel Burk from United Church rendered solos. Kenneth McBurney and his family from the Reformed church gave a fine performance with their singing. Rev Roberts from the Baptist church gave a solo, and Rev Archdeacon John Salter from St Paul's entertained us with some very funny stories.

Rev E Smith from the Presbyterian church and Jonathan related the story of Christmas.

Bernie Costello and Mark DeLarge from St Mary's entertained the members with several musical selections.

The president thanked the ministers for their entertainment.

Rev Archdeacon John Salter gave the Benediction.

A very enjoyable evening was brought to a close.



There's no time to celebrate like New Year's as the crowd at Fairview Manor proved Saturday night with party hats, horns, balloons, dancing and more. The Ritchie Family provided music for the evening.

Toys won and then donated

Mrs Bill Gomme was the lucky winner of the bag of toys valued at \$70 from Lee Pro Hardware.

Mrs Gomme donated the toys to the Grant children who lost their home in a recent fire.

Booster draw

The following are the winners of the Almonte Centennial Booster Club draw.

First prize was won by Doris Morton of Almonte, second by Percy Schroeder of Smiths Falls and third by D Distasio of Limoges, Ontario.

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